

Other practical-related skills, including analysis and evaluation of data may be assessed in the externally assessed components.

Edexcel reserves the right to:

- make it a requirement that centre staff undertake appropriate training to ensure the correct application of the verification process of practical skills
- arrange a centre visit to inspect procedures for the verification of practical skills.

Students are expected to follow the conventions for the collection and presentation of data as set out in the following document issued by the Institute of Biology:

Biological Nomenclature — Standard Terms and Expression Used in the Teaching of Biology, 3rd Edition (Institute of Biology, 2000) ISBN 0900490365.

Edexcel will issue centres with exemplar practical assessment material for Unit 6, Individual Investigation.

10.2 Part 2: Individual investigation (45 marks)

Students will present a written report, of between 2700 and 3300 words, of an experimental investigation they have devised and carried out. The Individual Investigation in Unit 6 is an individual practical project, which is designed to show progression from the internal assessment in the AS course.

Each student is required to carry out an extended practical project. It is suggested that it takes the equivalent of two weeks of normal lesson and homework time. Students will be assessed on their ability to plan and carry out experimental procedures, to interpret their experimental results and to report on their work.

At all times during the project, from initial planning to writing up, students should be encouraged to discuss their ideas with their teachers. This is particularly important in the early stages when students are choosing the topics of their investigations. Teachers may offer general guidance without penalty. The writing of the report must be entirely the student's own work.

Assessment is based on written work produced by the student.

The report must include presentation and analysis of the student's own numerical data. The report must be word processed and submitted electronically. This report will be marked by the teacher and the reports from selected students will be inspected by a moderator appointed by Edexcel, or alternatively the reports can be externally marked by Edexcel.

This assessment may be carried out at any time during the course, but the work should reflect the standard expected at Advanced GCE.

Students are required to include a cumulative word count at the bottom of each page.